

Mine in a box™

Managing Operations

Part A · Supervisor Prime Workbook

Systems that make good decisions inevitable.

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How this workbook works

Complete it over one roster, on shift, in the work. About 15 minutes on a shift. It is not homework for the end of a 12-hour day.

Honest answers matter. There are no marks and no wrong observations. Write what really happens on your shift today, not what should happen.

Bring the completed book to the Validation Lab. That day uses what you wrote.

If a figure, a meeting or a person is not available, write that down. It is a finding, not a failure.

Your roster at a glance

Task	When in the roster	About
1. Work out a number from what you can get today	First shift	15 min
2. Watch one real handover and one real pre-start	Shifts 1 and 2	15 min each
3. Where did my time go?	Two shifts, mid-roster	5 min, three times a shift
4. Time the circuit once	Mid-roster	20 min
5. The assumptions I inherited	Over the roster	15 min, twice
6. Decisions made live	Later shifts	2 min each
7. What we got away with	Later shifts	10 min
8. A have-a-go quiz	Mid-roster	10 min
9. How I would structure the roster	Last shift	20 min
10. Bring to the Lab	Last shift	10 min

Name: _____ **Site and pit:** _____ **Roster dates:** _____

Task 1. Work out a number from what you can get today

When: your first shift. About 15 minutes.

Take today's plan for your circuit. Turn it into a number the crew could say. Use only the figures you can actually get today. Where you cannot find a figure, write where you looked.

What	My figure, with its unit	Where I got it, or where I looked
Today's volume for my circuit (bcm or t)		
What one truck carries (bcm or t a load)		
Loads for the shift (loads)		
Hours the digger really digs (hours)		
Loads an hour (loads an hour)		
Trucks on the circuit (trucks)		

Example only: 9,000 bcm on the plan at 50 bcm a load is 180 loads. With 10 hours of digging, that is 18 loads an hour.

Could the crew say this number today? ☐ Yes ☐ No

The figures I could not get: _____

Who has them: _____

Task 2. Watch one real handover and one real pre-start

When: shifts 1 and 2. About 15 minutes each. Watch them as they run today. Do not change anything yet.

The handover I watched

Date: _____ **Started at:** _____ **Finished at:** _____ **(minutes:** ☐)

Did I leave knowing the real state of the pit? ☐ Yes ☐ No

What was covered:

What was missing, that I needed:

What was left set up for my shift, and what was not:

The pre-start I watched

Date: _____ **Started at:** _____ **Crew out of the room at:** _____ **(minutes:** ☐ **)**

What was covered:

_____

_____

_____

Three operators asked afterwards, by name. Could they say their task and the shift's number?

Operator	Task said?	Number said?	What they said
	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	
	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	
	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	

One thing I would change:

_____

_____

_____

_____

Task 3. Where did my time go?

When: two shifts, mid-roster. Three times a shift (mid-morning, after crib, before the end), write roughly how the last few hours went. One row each time: six rows.

Shift and time	Field (hours)	Office (hours)	Radio and phone (hours)	Firefighting (hours)	Other (hours)	Total (hours)
Shift 1, mid-morning						
Shift 1, after crib						
Shift 1, before the end						
Shift 2, mid-morning						
Shift 2, after crib						
Shift 2, before the end						

The biggest thing that pulled me out of the field:

The calls or interruptions that came back again and again:

What I would stop doing:

Task 4. Time the circuit once

When: mid-roster. About 20 minutes. Stand where you can see the whole circuit. Put a stopwatch on three trucks, not one.

Time	Truck 1	Truck 2	Truck 3	What the plan expects
Hang time: the digger waiting, bucket full, for a truck (seconds)				
Queue time: a truck waiting at the face for the one in front (seconds)				
Load time: spot plus load, truck stopped to last bucket (seconds)				
Cycle time: face to dump and back to the face (minutes)				

What this tells me about the circuit (short of trucks, too many trucks, the face, the road):

One thing I changed, and what I expected it to do:

Re-timed: hang ☐ seconds · queue ☐ seconds · load ☐ seconds · cycle ☐ minutes

Did it work? ☐ Yes ☐ No. **Why:**

Task 5. The assumptions I inherited

When: over the roster. About 15 minutes, twice. Your target and your plan rest on figures someone planned, budgeted or priced before your shift started. Find them, then check them against what you see over the roster, not one shift.

Ask your Superintendent or the planning team for the figures. If nobody can produce them, write that down: it is the first finding.

Assumption	What was planned (with unit)	What I see over the roster (same unit)	Matches?	So what for my number?
Digging rate: loads an hour (or bcm an hour) for my digger			☐ Yes ☐ No	
Trucks on my digger (trucks)			☐ Yes ☐ No	
Truck cycle time on my haul (minutes)			☐ Yes ☐ No	
Payload per truck (bcm or t)			☐ Yes ☐ No	
Delay allowed (% of engine hours)			☐ Yes ☐ No	
Support gear hours (dozers, graders, water carts) per 1,000 bcm or t (hours)			☐ Yes ☐ No	
People hours per machine engine hour (hours)			☐ Yes ☐ No	
Availability of my fleet (%)			☐ Yes ☐ No	
Haul distance (km)			☐ Yes ☐ No	

Who I asked, their answer, and the figures nobody could produce:

Task 6. Decisions made live

When: later shifts. Two minutes each. Log five decisions made during the shift, on the radio or on the spot, that someone had to make because nothing was decided before.

What was decided	Who made it	Made again next shift?	Should it have been decided before the work?	By whom
		☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	
		☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	
		☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	
		☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	
		☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	

The one that cost the most time, and why:

What would have to be decided before the work, so it is not made live again:

Task 7. What we got away with

When: later shifts. About 10 minutes. In your own words.

What nearly went wrong this roster, and did not, this time:

What else nearly went wrong:

What the crew walks past every shift (a standard nobody holds):

What I walk past:

What would have to change so it does not happen again:

Task 8. A have-a-go quiz

When: mid-roster. About 10 minutes. Answer from what you know today. There are no marks. The Lab will come back to these.

1. What does a good face look like?

2. Who sets your shift target today, and how?

3. Is a circuit better slightly under-trucked or slightly over-trucked? Why?

4. Could your crew say this shift's number in loads? ☐ Yes ☐ No

How do you know?

5. What decides how many loads an hour your digger can do?

6. What do you do when the target cannot be reached with the crew and gear you have?

Task 9. How I would structure the roster

When: your last shift, before you finish the book. About 20 minutes. Look back at tasks 1 to 8. What is not working in the way the roster runs today? Then say how you would run it, if it were up to you.

What is not working today:

How the shift should start:

How the crew should get its number and its work:

Where I should spend my time, and when:

When I should meet my Superintendent, and what for:

How the shift should end and be handed over:

What should be decided before the work, not on the radio:

Anything else:

Task 10. Bring to the Lab

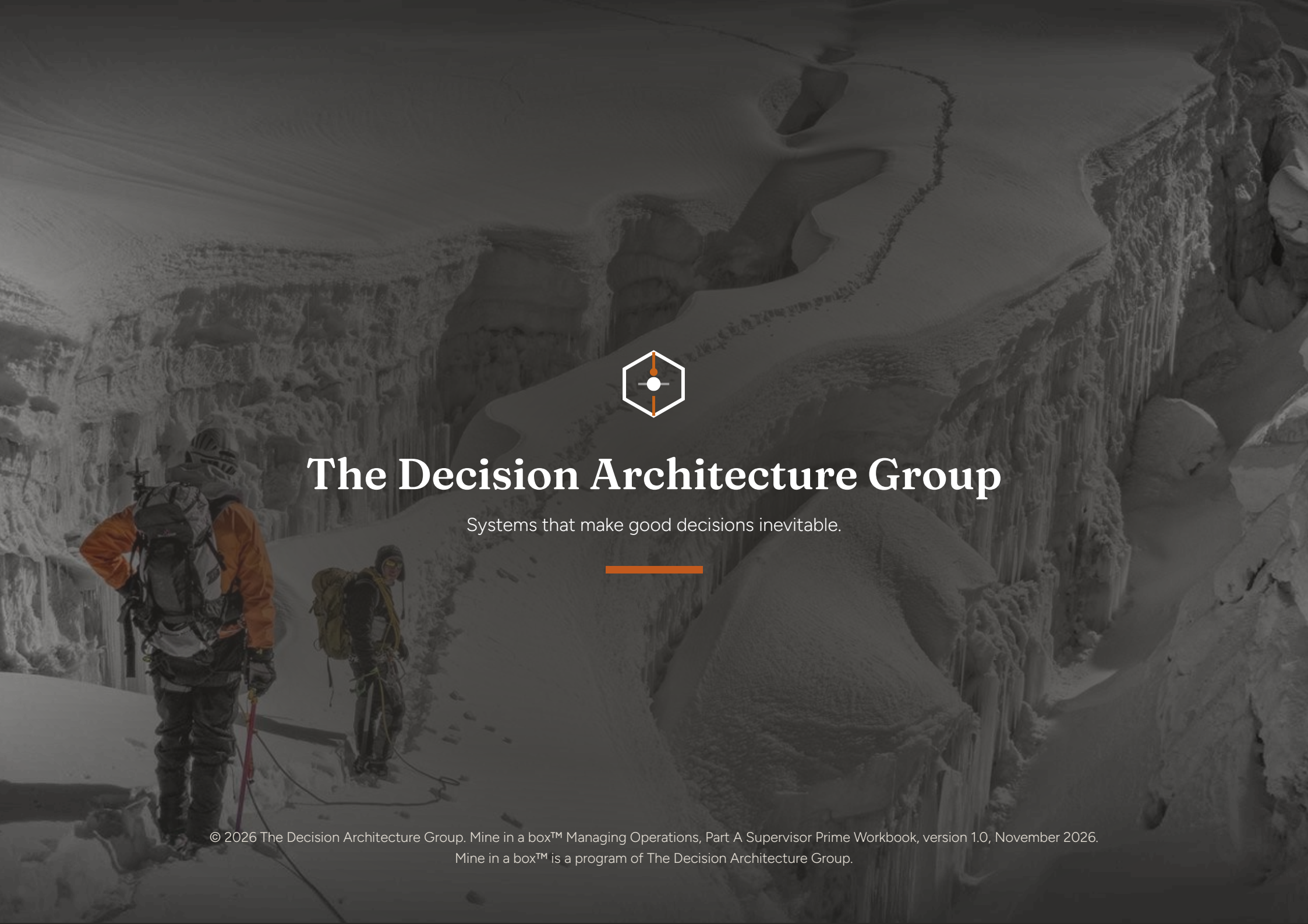
When: your last shift. About 10 minutes. Then bring this book to the Validation Lab.

Three things I now see about how we work:

One question I want answered at the Lab:

One thing I do not think will work here, and why:

Supervisor: Name _____ Signature _____ Date _____



The Decision Architecture Group

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